various faculty members. I was awarded eleven of them, concentrating on the more chemical. My first lecture was scheduled for February 7, and it was to deal with simple lipids. (To this day, I can't hear the phrase "simple lipids" without being instantly back—in imagination—in the Somerville apartment, wondering how I would make out.)

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By January 15, 1950, the option on The Stars, like Dust— was formalized and I started the novel a second time.

I still had my outline. I had never tried to write any story, however long, with an outline. None of my Foundation stories had been

outlined, though both "The Mule" and "—And Now You Don't" had been fearfully complex. Nor had I outlined Pebble in the Sky.

I found out quickly enough that my instinct was correct. I could not follow the outline. The story evolved as it rolled out of the typewriter and moved in its own direction, quite outside my control. For a while, I kept trying to drag the story back on the rails and then I gave up and threw the outline away.

I have never used an outline again for anything. In fact, I think it was my attempt to use an outline that is one of the reasons The Stars, like Dust— is the least favorite, to me, of my novels.

I had a completely false idea, by the way, of what reviews were like. On January 19, when Pebble in the Sky was officially published, I bought up all available New York and Boston papers, thinking that each would carry a review.

Then I thought there was some delay, and each day I would record my disappointment that nothing had appeared. However, Brad told me Doubleday got reviews from all over the country and he would save those that showed up for Pebble in the Sky and let me see them when I was next in New York.

Just to make sure, I signed up with a clipping service.

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The Campbell era of science fiction ended with the decade of the 1940s.

From 1938, when Campbell had first become editor of Astounding, through